Parishes of Glendermott & Strathfoyle

Sunday 11th October 2026

Twenty-Eight Sunday in Ordinary Time

Be clothed in ….

Jesus' favourite way of teaching was by telling stories or parables. In today's gospel, he tells a story about a banquet prepared by a King for his son's wedding. When everything is ready for the feast, the king sends his servants, not once but twice, to call the invited guests to come. When these refuse to come, for one reason or another, he finally asks his servants to go to the crossroads in the town and invite everyone they can find, good and bad alike, to come to the wedding. These come, and the ***'wedding hall is filled'*** (Mt 22:10).

Like most of the parables of Jesus, this is a story about the Kingdom of God. All are called to be part of the kingdom, but not everyone appreciates the invitation, or responds to it appropriately. Sadly, despite repeated invitations, they refuse to come. Instead, they seize the servants, mistreat and kill them. This refers to the hostile reception given to the prophets.

All are invited, good and bad alike, until the wedding hall is filled.
What Jesus is saying is that everyone is invited to the Kingdom of God. All kinds of people are called to be part of God's new world. It does not belong to an elite group of specially chosen ones. It encompasses saints and sinners.

The only requirement is a 'wedding garment' (Mt 22:11-12). But what is this wedding garment? St Paul gives us the answer: **"You should be clothed in sincere compassion, in kindness and humility, gentleness and patience…. Over all these clothes, to keep them together and complete them, put on love."** (Colossions 3: 12-15)

World Mission Sunday - 18th October 2026

Next weekend the Church celebrates World Mission Sunday, the weekend which the Pope annually invites all Catholics throughout the world to support the Churches missionary life.
The second collection next weekend is the Annual Mission collection

Baptisms – We welcome into God's family: **Zoe Catherine Barr**, Oak Country Park.

Anniversaries – For those whose anniversaries occur around this time: Robert McMenamin, Aidan Quigley, Rose & Willie McLaughlin, Grace Shiels, Samuel Fraser, Sarah Duddy, William Strawbridge, Robbie Herron, Maeve Kerr, Paula McElwee, Shiela Quigg.

Offertory Collections: **Glendermott: £4,425.00 Strathfoyle: £525.00**
Second Collection next weekend is the Annual Mission Collection
Thank you for your generosity to the parish collections.

What is university actually for? - Queen's Catholic Chaplaincy is delighted to welcome **Dr Paul Shrimpton**, writer, historian and scholar of St John Henry Newman, for a public lecture exploring Newman's vision of **human flourishing at university**. On **Monday 12th October, 7.00pm** Queen's Catholic Chaplaincy, 30–38 Elmwood Avenue, Belfast. Students, staff, alumni and friends are welcome.

PRAY FOR THE NATIONAL GATHERING OF THE CHURCH IN IRELAND: Bishops, priests, religious and lay people from across Ireland will gather for the National Synodal Assembly on Saturday, 17 October, to pray, listen and discern what God may be asking of the Catholic Church in Ireland at this time. Bishop Michael Router and seven delegates will represent the Diocese of Derry. Please remember Bishop Michael, our diocesan delegates and everyone taking part in your prayers. Find out more on: https://derrydiocese.org/national-synodal-assembly

Vocations: We pray that the men called to be priests of our diocese will know the truth of St Paul's words in our second reading, **"There is nothing I cannot master with the help of the One who gives me strength."**

Unlocking the Mystery of the Bible Many of us want to read the Bible but can find it difficult to understand. The Parish will be running 'Unlocking the Mystery of the Bible', an eight-part course that will help us to understand the main story of the Bible and how all the different parts fit together. It gives the 'big picture' and helps us see what the Bible is really about. We will meet on Monday evenings starting on 2nd November at 8pm (after 7.30pm Mass) in the Parish Hall, St Columb's Church. Sessions will begin with prayer, followed by a video presentation and small group discussion. By the end, you'll feel more confident reading the Bible and have a better understanding of how you fit into God's plan. To register for the course, please leave your name and contact details at the Parish Office (028 71 342303 or email secretary@watersideparish.net).